

When we think about our careers, and what we need to do to establish them, we often forget about the need to develop an essential skill: **communication**. If you start reading through the job descriptions in a industry, you will find that the vast majority of jobs require one or more of the following:

- Effective communication skills
- Interpersonal skills
- Ability to work in a team
- Negotiation skills
- Conflict resolution skills
- Report writing skills

What all of these skills have in common is that they involve the use of language to achieve a particular purpose. And for this reason, having good language skills is essential in any working environment.

In a career context, good language skills can also:

- **Affect your credibility.** Poor grammar indicates to a prospective employer that you are sloppy, while flawless grammar indicates that you pay attention to detail.
- **Improve your relationships with your co-workers.** If you are able to express yourself clearly, you can eliminate the confusion and misunderstanding that often leads to conflict.
- **Increase your chances of being promoted.**
- **Help you to create a good impression.**
- **Improve your ability to persuade others** (which is a valuable skill in the working world).